

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4**PART A Group Interaction**

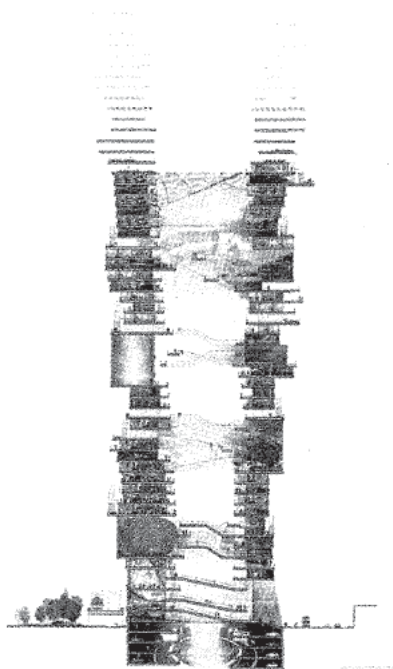
Below is an article about an award-winning proposal:

The city in the sky

The 'Endless City' project is an ambitious plan which suggests skyscrapers of the future may one day house an entire city. London is the proposed city for this project, which could accommodate thousands of people – as well as schools, offices, shops and even parks.

The 'Endless City' project would see a giant 300m skyscraper built with its own complete ecosystem featuring offices, shops and 'huge' parks. Residents would be able to walk around intertwining ramps in the interior of the giant building, passing through shopping, commercial and residential areas. The building would include many of the features that can be found in a city environment, such as public spaces, entertainment zones and shopping areas. Different areas of the building would be linked by a series of bridges and walkways helping to 'increase exchanges, communications and interactions' and the different levels will offer stunning views across London's skyline.

The proposal has been drawn up by SURE Architecture, whose design has already won the SkyScrapers and SuperSkyScrapers Competition. The firm insists the building would be a great space-saver in dense cities which have previously spread outwards rather than upwards. The architects hope the project will encourage people to think about 'vertical city designs' that would, in the future, bring the feeling of a city inside a building, and residents would never have to leave.



Your group is now discussing the 'Endless City' proposal. You may want to talk about:

- what other facilities should be included in the Endless City
- the pros and cons of living in the Endless City
- whether a similar proposal would be popular in Hong Kong
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you like living in a high-rise building?
2. Do you think Hong Kong has too many tall buildings?
3. Which do you prefer: living in a quiet village or a busy city?
4. Would you like to live in a building you never had to leave?
5. Do you think it is important to have a nice view from your home?
6. What can be done to solve the problem of land shortage?
7. What are the pros and cons of having only high-rise buildings in a city?
8. Do you think that a city's architecture reflects the culture of a city?